MAGNA-Q PATHWAY SERIES — VOLUME TWO

The 2027 Match: Application, Match Week and Aftermath

A complete operational guide for international medical graduates applying in September 2026 for residency training beginning in July 2027

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Companion volume: *The Complete Pathway: ECFMG Certification to Match Day*

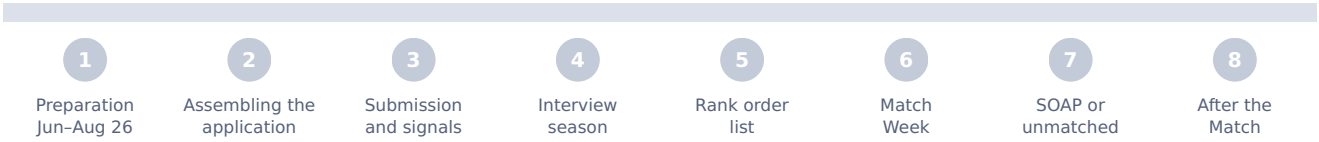
Study. Apply. Match. | This document provides general information on published processes, policies and statistics. It does not constitute individual academic, legal or immigration advice.

Document Summary

This volume covers the application year in operational detail: what is assembled and when, how the application is transmitted, how interviews are obtained and conducted, how the rank order list determines the outcome, precisely what happens during Match Week hour by hour, and what follows in either event. It assumes the reader is eligible to participate and concentrates on execution. Eligibility itself is treated in the companion volume.

- The season has **eight operational phases**. A progress diagram marks the reader's position at the end of each.
- Two registrations are mandatory and separate: the application service (**ERAS**, or **ResidencyCAS** for Emergency Medicine and Obstetrics and Gynecology) and the **NRMP**. Completing one does not accomplish the other.
- Applications may be submitted from **2 September 2026** but no programme reviews any application before **23 September 2026**. Completeness by that date, not speed of submission, determines who is read.
- NRMP registration opens **15 September 2026 at 12:00 p.m. ET**; standard registration closes **29 January 2027 at 11:59 p.m. ET**, after which a supplementary fee of fifty dollars applies.
- Rank order lists open **1 February 2027** and must be certified by **3 March 2027 at 9:00 p.m. ET**. That same deadline is the date by which international applicants must satisfy ECFMG verification requirements. An uncertified list does not enter the algorithm.
- Match Week runs **15 to 19 March 2027**. Applicants learn *whether* they matched at **10:00 a.m. ET on Monday 15 March** and *where* at **12:00 p.m. ET on Friday 19 March**. SOAP occupies the interval, with four offer rounds on Thursday 18 March.
- Participation is governed by a binding agreement. A position accepted in the Match or in SOAP creates a commitment enforceable against both parties.

THE EIGHT PHASES OF THE 2027 APPLICATION YEAR



The five errors that end most seasons

Before the detail, the failure modes. Each is common, each is avoidable, and each is fatal in the same season it occurs.

1. **Submitting on time but incomplete.** A missing letter or an unverified credential on 23 September is functionally equivalent to not applying.
2. **Registering with the application service and not with the NRMP.** A full season of interviews yields nothing if the applicant is absent from the algorithm.
3. **Applying to too few programmes, or to programmes that do not consider the applicant.** A list of eighty places that decline international applicants is worse than a list of forty that do not.
4. **Failing to certify the rank order list.** Entering a list is not certifying it. An uncertified list is not processed.
5. **Arriving at Match Week unprepared for the possibility of SOAP.** Documents assembled after 10:00 a.m. on Monday are assembled too late.

PHASE ONE

Preparation: June to August 2026

The 2027 ERAS season opened on 4 June 2026 and runs to 31 May 2027. The months before September are not idle time; they are when the material that programmes will read is created. Nothing in this phase can be compressed later.

Confirming eligibility to participate

International applicants must satisfy ECFMG verification requirements to participate in the Match. The deadline is **3 March 2027** — the same date as rank order list certification — but treating March as the working target is a serious error, because ECFMG must have processed the applicant's documents and reported eligibility to the NRMP by then, and processing does not begin until every supporting document has arrived.

Obtaining the ERAS token

International applicants request an ERAS token through MyIntealth. The token is the credential that opens a MyERAS application. Tokens have historically become available around the start of the season; request it as soon as it is available rather than in late August, when support queues lengthen.

Letters of recommendation

For the 2027 season all letters are transmitted through the **AAMC Letter Writer Portal**. The practical consequences are worth stating plainly. The letter writer must act, within a system they may not have used before, on a schedule the applicant does not control. Requests made in August routinely arrive in October.

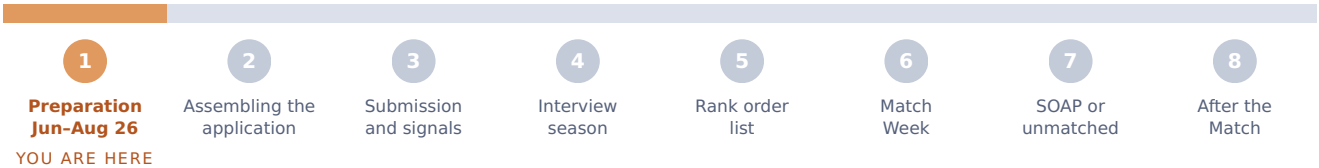
- Ask early, and ask in person or by video where possible.
- Provide the writer with a current curriculum vitae, a draft personal statement and a short note recalling specific work you did together. A letter written from a template is recognisable and worth little.
- Confirm the writer is willing to write a *strong* letter. A lukewarm letter is more damaging than a missing one.
- Track receipt in the portal. Do not assume submission because a writer said they would submit.

The personal statement

One statement is sufficient for many applicants; those applying to more than one specialty require one per specialty, and MyERAS permits assigning different statements to different programmes. Two observations, offered as the consensus of published advice rather than as rule: the statement should explain the applicant's reasons for the specialty and what they intend to contribute, and it should be free of error. Programme directors report that carelessness in a document the applicant had months to prepare is read as evidence about the applicant's work.

> A NOTE FOR INTERNATIONAL APPLICANTS WRITING IN A SECOND LANGUAGE
>
> Clear, plain English is not a lesser register. Short sentences, concrete detail and specific clinical examples read as confidence. Elaborate vocabulary used slightly incorrectly reads as the opposite. Have the statement read by someone who will tell you the truth about it, and prefer accuracy over ornament.

PROGRESS — PHASE 1



PHASE TWO

Assembling the Application and the Programme List

What the application contains

The MyERAS application comprises personal and educational information, experiences, scholarly work, licensure and examination history, the personal statement, a photograph, letters of recommendation, the Medical Student Performance Evaluation and the medical school transcript. Two points of detail matter for the 2027 season: the section previously titled *Publications* is now **Scholarly Work**, and letters arrive through the Letter Writer Portal rather than by the former mechanism.

Experience entries reward specificity. An entry that states what the applicant did, over what period, and what resulted from it is read; an entry that recites a job title is not. Where the system permits designation of the most meaningful experiences, that designation should be used deliberately, because those entries are the ones most often discussed at interview.

The programme list

The NRMP Programme Directory lists over six thousand PGY-1 and PGY-2 programmes participating in the Main Residency Match. The applicant's task is not to survey them but to identify the subset that will genuinely consider an application, and then to apply broadly within it.

Filters that should be applied first

Filter	Why it decides the outcome
Visa sponsorship	An application to a programme that sponsors nothing is an application that cannot succeed, however strong. Confirm the classification sponsored, not merely that sponsorship exists.
Years since graduation	Many programmes apply a limit, commonly in the region of three to five years. Limits are inconsistently published and must be confirmed programme by programme.
Minimum examination scores	Some programmes state a Step 2 CK threshold. Where stated, it is generally applied.
Requirement for United States clinical experience	Some programmes require hands-on experience rather than observership. Read the requirement precisely.
Track record with international graduates	The published roster of current residents shows whether a programme has trained international graduates and from which countries. A programme with that history is equipped to read the application; one without it is being asked to do something unfamiliar.

How many programmes

No responsible source states a universal number, because the correct figure depends on the applicant's profile and specialty. What can be stated is the mechanism: the probability of matching rises with the number of programmes at which one is ranked, and the number of programmes ranked is bounded by the number of interviews obtained, which is in turn bounded by the number and quality of applications sent. Applicants with unsuccessful examination attempts, with distant graduation years, or requiring visa sponsorship should expect to apply to substantially more programmes than an applicant without those features, and should budget accordingly, since ERAS fees rise with the number of programmes per specialty.

Parallel plans and multiple specialties

Applying to a second, less competitive specialty alongside a first choice is a recognised strategy rather than an admission of weakness, and it requires genuine preparation: a separate personal statement, ideally a letter from that specialty, and a coherent explanation at interview. Applicants should also understand the distinction between **categorical** positions, which continue to completion of training, and

preliminary positions, which last one year and require the holder to obtain a further position afterwards. Both appear in the Match. International applicants are disproportionately represented in preliminary positions in some specialties, and a preliminary year should be entered into knowingly.

PROGRESS — PHASE 2



PHASE THREE

Submission, Signals and Registration: September 2026

Date and time	Event
2 Sep 2026, 9:00 a.m. ET	Applicants may begin submitting MyERAS applications to programmes
15 Sep 2026, 12:00 p.m. ET	NRMP registration opens; the applicant creates an R3 account
23 Sep 2026	Programmes begin reviewing applications

Source: NRMP 2027 Main Residency Match applicant calendar; AAMC 2027 ERAS timeline.

The three-week interval, and what it is for

Between 2 and 23 September nothing is read. The interval exists so that applications can be completed, and it is the most misunderstood feature of the season. Applicants compete to submit on the first morning and then spend three weeks with an outstanding letter or an unverified credential. The correct use of the interval is to close every gap in the file before programmes open it.

> REGISTRATION WITH THE NRMP IS A SEPARATE ACT
>
> Registration with ERAS or ResidencyCAS does not register the applicant for the Match. The NRMP requires its own registration, opening 15 September 2026 at 12:00 p.m. ET. Standard registration closes 29 January 2027 at 11:59 p.m. ET; registration after that date incurs an additional fee of fifty dollars. An applicant who is not registered with the NRMP cannot be matched, irrespective of how many interviews they attend.

Programme signals

A programme signal is a token attached to an application indicating particular interest in that programme. Programmes treat signals as one consideration among several when deciding whom to interview. The essential facts are these.

- The number of signals available **varies by specialty**. Each specialty sets its own allotment in consultation with the AAMC, taking account of the size of the specialty and the volume of applications it receives.
- Participation is **optional at programme level**. Some programmes within a participating specialty decline to receive signals. The list of participating programmes for the 2027 season is published in late August 2026 and should be checked before signals are allocated.
- AAMC guidance is to **use every signal available** and to direct signals to the programmes of greatest interest, including any at which the applicant has rotated.
- AAMC has reported that sending a signal was associated with a **higher probability of receiving an interview invitation in every participating specialty**. Among the levers remaining to an applicant in September, this is the best evidenced.

Allocating signals as an international applicant

Signals are scarce and should be spent where they can change a decision. Two failure modes are common. The first is signalling the most prestigious programmes on the list irrespective of whether they have ever trained an international graduate; the signal is consumed and the outcome is unchanged. The second is signalling only programmes that would have interviewed the applicant regardless; the signal is wasted on a decision already made. The productive target is the programme that plausibly considers the applicant, receives more qualified applications than it can interview, and has no other means of knowing that this applicant is serious about it.

> TO VERIFY BEFORE ALLOCATING
>
> Signal allotments for the 2027 season are set by each specialty and published by the AAMC, and some specialties now operate tiered signals of differing weight. Confirm the number available to you, and whether tiers apply, on the AAMC programme signalling page and within your MyERAS portal before committing any signal. Do not rely on figures circulated in applicant communities or on commercial advising sites.

PROGRESS — PHASE 3



PHASE FOUR

Interview Season: October 2026 to January 2027

How invitations arrive

Invitations arrive by email, frequently through scheduling platforms, and frequently with limited slots allocated on a first-response basis. Applicants in other time zones are at a structural disadvantage that can be substantially reduced by preparation: enable notifications, check at intervals through the day, and have a calendar ready so that a slot can be taken within minutes rather than hours. An invitation declined by silence is not recoverable.

Preparing the virtual interview

Interviews for international applicants are almost invariably conducted by video. The setting is part of the assessment whether or not anyone intends it to be.

- Test the connection, camera and microphone on the actual platform in advance, and have a backup connection identified — a mobile hotspot, a second location — before the day.
- Position the camera at eye level, light the face from in front rather than behind, and use a plain background.
- Confirm the time in Eastern Time and in local time, and write both down. Time-zone errors on interview day are common and are read as carelessness.
- Dress as for an in-person interview.

What is being assessed

Programmes are assessing whether the applicant will be a competent, reliable and agreeable colleague for the duration of training. Published surveys of programme directors consistently place interpersonal skills and interactions during the interview among the highest-weighted factors in ranking decisions, above several of the metrics that dominate the earlier screening stage. This has a direct implication: the screening stage is decided by the file, and the ranking stage is decided substantially by the person.

Applicants should be able to speak fluently about every entry in their own application, about why this specialty, why this programme, and about their clinical reasoning in cases they have described. Questions asked of the programme should demonstrate that its website and structure have been read.

COMMUNICATIONS AND CONDUCT

Post-interview communication is governed by policy and by programme preference; some programmes explicitly ask that no letters of intent or thank-you notes be sent. Where a preference is stated, follow it exactly. Applicants should also be aware that certain questions — concerning marital status, family plans, and other protected characteristics — are impermissible, and that an applicant is under no obligation to volunteer where else they have applied or how they intend to rank. Statements from a programme about how it intends to rank an applicant carry no binding force and should not influence the applicant's own list.

PROGRESS — PHASE 4



PHASE FIVE

The Rank Order List: February to 3 March 2027

Date and time	Event
1 Feb 2027, 12:00 p.m. ET	Ranking opens in the R3 system; programme quotas finalised in the Programme Directory
3 Mar 2027, 9:00 p.m. ET	Rank order list certification deadline; applicant withdrawal deadline; late registration deadline; **international applicant deadline to meet ECFMG verification requirements**

Source: NRMP 2027 Main Residency Match applicant calendar.

How the algorithm works, and what follows from it

The matching algorithm is applicant-proposing. It attempts to place each applicant at the most preferred programme on their list that will accept them, working down the list only where a placement is not possible. The consequence, which the NRMP states directly and which is worth internalising, is that an applicant's interests are best served by listing programmes in their **true order of preference**. There is no strategic advantage in ranking a programme higher because it seems more attainable, or lower because it seems out of reach. Doing so can only produce a worse outcome than honest ranking would have produced.

Practical rules

- **Rank every programme at which you would accept a position.** A programme omitted from the list cannot match you. A programme ranked last still matches you ahead of not matching at all.
- **Do not rank a programme you would refuse to attend.** A match is binding; there is no opportunity to decline afterwards.
- **Entering a list is not certifying it.** The list must be certified in the R3 system. An uncertified list does not enter the algorithm. Certify early and re-check the confirmation; do not leave it to the final hours of 3 March.
- **Supplemental rank order lists** are used where an applicant ranks advanced positions requiring a separate first year, allowing preliminary positions to be linked to those choices. Applicants in this situation should read the NRMP guidance on supplemental lists specifically.

- **Couples** may link their lists so that pairs of programmes are considered together. This has its own rules and deadlines.
- **3 March is also the ECFMG verification deadline.** An international applicant whose verification is incomplete on that date is not eligible to be matched, regardless of the state of their rank order list.

BETWEEN 3 MARCH AND 15 MARCH

Nothing is required of the applicant in this interval and nothing further can be influenced. Programmes cannot change their lists; applicants cannot change theirs. Communications received during this period, in either direction, alter nothing.

PROGRESS — PHASE 5



PHASE SIX

Match Week: 15 to 19 March 2027

Match Week is conducted to a fixed schedule with hard deadlines. The table below sets out every time that concerns an applicant. All times are Eastern Time. Applicants outside the United States should convert each one and record it locally before the week begins.

Day and time	What happens
Mon 15 Mar 10:00 a.m.	Applicants learn **whether** they matched, by email and in the R3 system. The result states matched, partially matched, or unmatched. It does not state where.
Mon 15 Mar 10:00 a.m.	SOAP begins for eligible applicants. The *List of Unfilled Programs* appears in the R3 system under the SOAP tab, showing only programmes for which that applicant is eligible.
Mon 15 Mar 11:00 a.m.	SOAP applicants may begin preparing applications in the application service designated by each programme.
Tue 16 Mar 8:00 a.m.	Programmes begin reviewing SOAP applications and may contact applicants and begin interviewing.
Thu 18 Mar 9:00–11:00 a.m.	**SOAP Round 1.** Offers appear at 9:00; the applicant deadline to accept or reject is 11:00. The *List of Unfilled Programs* is then updated.
Thu 18 Mar 12:00–2:00 p.m.	**SOAP Round 2.** Offers at 12:00; accept or reject by 2:00.
Thu 18 Mar 3:00–5:00 p.m.	**SOAP Round 3.** Offers at 3:00; accept or reject by 5:00.
Thu 18 Mar 6:00–8:00 p.m.	**SOAP Round 4.** Offers at 6:00; accept or reject by 8:00.
Thu 18 Mar 9:00 p.m.	SOAP ends with posting of the final *List of Unfilled Programs*, now including programmes that did not participate in SOAP. Applicants may begin contacting all remaining unfilled programmes.
Fri 19 Mar 12:00 p.m.	**Match Day.** Full results released to applicants by email and in the R3 system. Advance Data Tables published by the NRMP.

Source: NRMP 2027 Main Residency Match applicant calendar and 2027 Match Week and SOAP calendar.

Monday morning

The Monday message is deliberately limited. An applicant who matched learns only that fact and waits until Friday for the destination; there is no method of discovering it earlier and no purpose in attempting to. An applicant who did not match, or who matched only partially, moves immediately into a process measured in hours. It is for this reason that preparation for SOAP is undertaken in February, by applicants who fully expect to match. The cost of preparing and not needing it is one afternoon. The cost of needing it and not having prepared is the year.

PROGRESS — PHASE 6



PHASE SEVEN

SOAP, and What to Do If You Do Not Match

The Supplemental Offer and Acceptance Program places eligible unmatched and partially matched applicants into positions that remained unfilled after the algorithm ran. It is a real second chance and it is conducted at speed.

The rules that carry the heaviest penalties

- **The NRMP is the authoritative source for SOAP eligibility.** The *List of Unfilled Programs* shows only the positions for which that applicant is eligible, based on their matched status. Applicants are responsible for applying only to positions for which they are eligible.
- **Applicants and their representatives may not contact a programme until that programme has contacted them.** This applies to the applicant, to friends, and to mentors acting on their behalf. It is among the most frequently violated provisions and among the most damaging.
- **Applicants who are not eligible for SOAP** may not apply to or contact any Match-participating programme, whatever its SOAP status, until SOAP concludes. They may apply to or contact non-Match-participating programmes from 8:00 a.m. on Tuesday of Match Week.
- **An offer accepted in SOAP is binding**, enforced under the Match Participation Agreement, exactly as a match through the algorithm is binding.
- **Offers not answered expire**, and an offer rejected or expired is not extended to that applicant again in a later round. Each round allows two hours to decide.

What to have ready before Monday

Applicants who succeed in SOAP are, without exception, applicants who prepared in advance. The following should exist in final form before Match Week opens: an updated curriculum vitae; a general personal statement and, if a parallel specialty is contemplated, a second one; letters already in the system; a shortlist of specialties in which unfilled positions historically appear; a quiet room, a reliable connection and a cleared calendar for Monday to Thursday; and the times in the table above converted to local time. Applicants should also decide in advance, calmly, what they would accept: a preliminary year, a different specialty, a different region. That decision is made badly under a two-hour deadline.

After SOAP concludes

From 9:00 p.m. on Thursday, applicants may contact any remaining unfilled programme directly, and the final list includes programmes that did not participate in SOAP. Positions continue to be filled during this period and in the weeks that follow.

If the year does not produce a position

This outcome is common enough that it should be discussed without euphemism. In the 2026 Match, a substantial minority of international applicants did not match; the figures appear in the companion volume and in the table later in this document. The applicants who succeed on a second attempt are generally those who diagnose the specific reason for the first failure and address it, rather than those who repeat the same application with more programmes attached.

- **Too few interviews** indicates a screening problem: the score, the attempts, the graduation year, the absence of United States clinical experience, or a programme list aimed at places that do not consider the applicant.
- **Interviews but no match** indicates a ranking problem: interview performance, or a list too short to absorb ordinary variance.
- **Remedies with evidence behind them** include obtaining hands-on United States clinical experience and strong United States letters, adding a research or clinical post that keeps the applicant clinically current, and broadening both the specialty and the geographic range of the list.
- Time out of clinical practice is itself a filter at many programmes. Keeping clinically active between attempts matters.

PROGRESS — PHASE 7



PHASE EIGHT

After the Match: March to July 2027

The binding commitment

A position obtained through the Match or through SOAP creates a binding commitment on both the applicant and the programme, enforced under the Match Participation Agreement. An applicant may not accept a different position, and a programme may not withdraw the offer, except through the formal waiver process operated by the NRMP. Waivers are granted on defined grounds and are not a mechanism for changing one's mind. Applicants contemplating any departure from a matched commitment should read the NRMP waiver policy before taking any step, including any conversation with another programme.

Immigration status

For applicants who are neither United States citizens nor lawful permanent residents, the interval between March and July is dominated by immigration processing, and it is short. Most international residents train under **J-1 sponsorship through ECFMG's Exchange Visitor Sponsorship Program**. A minority of programmes sponsor the **H-1B** classification; this route is commonly associated with a requirement that Step 3 has already been passed, which is one reason some applicants sit Step 3 before matching. The graduate medical education office of the matched programme initiates and directs the process. Every document requested should be returned the day it is requested. This guide describes these arrangements descriptively only; applicants should rely on official government sources and, where appropriate, qualified legal advice.

Certification and credentialing

ECFMG Certification must be complete before accredited training may begin. Any outstanding requirement — a Pathway document, an OET result, an unverified credential — becomes urgent at this point, and the interval available to resolve it is now measured in weeks rather than months. In parallel the applicant will complete state licensing documentation, hospital credentialing, occupational health clearance, and payroll and identity paperwork.

Preparing for the first year

Residency ordinarily commences on or about 1 July, generally preceded by an orientation period. Applicants who have not previously worked in the United States health system commonly report that the initial difficulty is not clinical knowledge but system fluency: documentation, the electronic record, the structure of ward rounds, the manner in which a patient is presented, and the boundaries of an intern's authority. These are learnable in advance and are worth learning in advance.



The 2027 Season on One Page

Date and time (ET)	Event	What the applicant must have done
4 Jun 2026	2027 ERAS season opens	Request ERAS token through MyIntealth; begin letter requests
Late Aug 2026	Participating signalling programmes published	Confirm signal allotment and participating programmes before allocating
2 Sep 2026, 9:00 a.m.	ERAS submission opens	Application complete or near complete; signals allocated
15 Sep 2026, 12:00 p.m.	NRMP registration opens	Create R3 account — separate from ERAS
23 Sep 2026	Programmes begin reviewing	**Every element received and verified**
Oct 2026 – Jan 2027	Interview season	Respond to invitations within hours; convert all times to local time
29 Jan 2027, 11:59 p.m.	NRMP standard registration deadline	Registered; after this a fifty dollar fee applies
1 Feb 2027, 12:00 p.m.	Ranking opens in R3	Begin building the list; prepare SOAP materials in parallel
3 Mar 2027, 9:00 p.m.	ROL certification deadline; withdrawal deadline; **ECFMG verification deadline**	**List certified**, not merely entered; ECFMG requirements met
15 Mar 2027, 10:00 a.m.	Match status released; SOAP begins	SOAP documents ready; calendar cleared to Thursday
16 Mar 2027, 8:00 a.m.	Programmes review SOAP applications	Await contact; do not initiate contact
18 Mar 2027, 9 a.m. – 8 p.m.	SOAP Rounds 1 to 4	Available at every round; two hours to answer each offer
18 Mar 2027, 9:00 p.m.	SOAP ends; final unfilled list posted	May now contact remaining unfilled programmes directly
19 Mar 2027, 12:00 p.m.	**Match Day**	Results released
Mar – Jun 2027	Visa, licensing, credentialing	Return every requested document the day it is requested
c. 1 Jul 2027	Residency begins	Certification complete; onboarding done

Sources: NRMP 2027 Main Residency Match applicant calendar; NRMP 2027 Match Week and SOAP calendar; AAMC 2027 ERAS materials. Verified 18 August 2026.

The Statistical Context

Measure, 2026 Main Residency Match	Figure
Non-United States citizen international graduates, active applicants	11,944
Non-United States citizen international graduates matched to PGY-1	56.4 per cent
requiring visa sponsorship	54.4 per cent
United States permanent residents	67.9 per cent
United States citizen international graduates matched to PGY-1 (2025)	67.8 per cent
Internal Medicine positions offered / proportion filled	11,632 / 95.2 per cent
Pediatrics positions offered / proportion filled	3,185 / 94.4 per cent
Family Medicine positions unfilled	899
Programmes in the NRMP Programme Directory (PGY-1 and PGY-2)	over 6,000

Sources: NRMP 2026 Main Residency Match Results and Data and accompanying press materials; NRMP 2025 Match results; NRMP Programme Directory. The division by visa status was published for the first time in 2026.

Two readings of these figures are available and both are correct. The first is that the 2026 rate for non-United States citizen international graduates was the lowest in five years, and that requiring visa sponsorship is now a measured and published disadvantage of some thirteen percentage points. The second is that unfilled positions existed in substantial numbers — nearly nine hundred in Family Medicine alone — and that a proportion of applicants who did not match had not, in fact, applied to the programmes that went unfilled. The figures describe a pool. What determines an individual outcome is the specific set of decisions catalogued in this guide.

Official Sources

Resource	Address
NRMP 2027 Main Residency Match applicant calendar	nrmp.org/match-calendars/main-residency-applicants
NRMP Match Week and SOAP information for applicants	nrmp.org/residency-applicants/match-week · /soap
NRMP Programme Directory	programdirectory.nrmp.org
NRMP policies, waivers and violation reporting	nrmp.org/policies
NRMP Match fees	nrmp.org/intro-to-the-match/match-fees
AAMC ERAS for residency applicants	students-residents.aamc.org/eras
AAMC programme signalling, 2027 season	students-residents.aamc.org — programme signalling pages
ResidencyCAS (Emergency Medicine, Obstetrics and Gynecology)	residencycas.org
ECFMG Match eligibility and verification requirements	ecfmg.org · myintealth.app
ECFMG Exchange Visitor Sponsorship Program (J-1)	ecfmg.org/evsp
FREIDA programme directory	freida.ama-assn.org

Glossary

Advanced position
A position beginning in the second postgraduate year, requiring the applicant to obtain a separate first-year position.

Categorical position
A position continuing through to completion of training in that specialty.

Certification (of a rank order list)
The act of confirming a completed list in the R3 system. A list that is entered but not certified does not enter the algorithm.

Couples Match
An arrangement permitting two applicants to link their rank order lists so that pairs of programmes are considered together.

ERAS token
The credential permitting an applicant to open a MyERAS application; obtained by international graduates through MyIntealth.

Letter Writer Portal
The AAMC system through which letters of recommendation are submitted for the 2027 season.

List of Unfilled Programs
The list, visible in the R3 system during Match Week, of positions that remain unfilled; filtered to show each applicant only the positions for which they are eligible.

Match Participation Agreement
The binding agreement governing participation. Positions obtained through the Match or SOAP create commitments enforceable under it.

Partially matched

Matched to one component of a required pair — for example an advanced position without a first year, or the reverse. Such applicants may be eligible for SOAP for the missing component.

Preliminary position

A one-year position that does not continue to completion of training.

Programme signal

A limited token indicating particular interest in a programme; numbers vary by specialty and programme participation is optional.

Quota

The number of positions a programme offers in the Match, finalised and viewable in the Programme Directory when ranking opens.

R3 system

The NRMP's Registration, Ranking and Results system, in which applicants register, build and certify rank order lists, and receive Match and SOAP results.

Rank order list

The list of programmes an applicant submits, in true order of preference, before the certification deadline.

Scholarly Work

The MyERAS section recording research and publications; formerly titled Publications.

SOAP

The Supplemental Offer and Acceptance Program, conducted during Match Week, through which eligible unmatched and partially matched applicants may receive offers for unfilled positions.

Supplemental rank order list

A list linking first-year positions to specific advanced choices on the primary list.

Waiver

The formal NRMP process by which a party may be released from a binding Match commitment, granted only on defined grounds.

> VERIFICATION STATEMENT
>
> All dates, times and procedural rules in this guide were verified on 18 August 2026 against the NRMP 2027 Main Residency Match applicant calendar, the NRMP 2027 Match Week and SOAP calendar, NRMP Match Week and SOAP policy pages, AAMC ERAS and programme signalling materials, and NRMP 2026 Results and Data. Times are stated in Eastern Time as published by the NRMP. Dates, fees and policies are subject to revision by the responsible organisations, and the applicant remains responsible for confirming them directly. This edition is scheduled for re-verification on 1 November 2026. Readers who identify an error are invited to report it so that it may be corrected and the correction recorded.